

KDP Preflight Checklist

The Print-Ready Pack · assembled by Sloom Studio · print-ready comic & book layout · sloom.studio

1 · Page size: trim and bleed

Your PDF page size must be exact. Pages with art running to the edge need bleed; KDP's bleed adds **0.125"** to the outside edges.

FORMAT	TRIM SIZE	PDF PAGE SIZE WITH BLEED
US comic single issue	6.625" × 10.25"	6.75" × 10.5"
Manga / digest	5" × 7.5"	5.125" × 7.75"
Trade paperback	6" × 9"	6.125" × 9.25"
Workbook / art book	8.5" × 11"	8.625" × 11.25"

$$\text{bleed page width} = \text{trim width} + 0.125 \quad \cdot \quad \text{bleed page height} = \text{trim height} + 0.25$$

Keep anything that must not be cut (lettering, panel borders you care about) at least 0.375" inside the trim edge.

2 · Interior margins and gutter (KDP paperback)

PAGE COUNT	INSIDE (GUTTER)	OUTSIDE MARGINS, NO BLEED	OUTSIDE MARGINS, WITH BLEED
24 – 150	0.375"	≥ 0.25"	≥ 0.375"
151 – 300	0.5"	≥ 0.25"	≥ 0.375"
301 – 500	0.625"	≥ 0.25"	≥ 0.375"
501 – 700	0.75"	≥ 0.25"	≥ 0.375"
701 – 828	0.875"	≥ 0.25"	≥ 0.375"

3 · Spine width (paperback cover math)

black & white, white paper: $\text{pages} \times 0.002252"$
black & white, cream paper: $\text{pages} \times 0.0025"$
standard color: $\text{pages} \times 0.002252"$ · premium color: $\text{pages} \times 0.002347"$

$$\text{full cover width} = \text{back trim} + \text{spine} + \text{front trim} + 0.25" \text{ bleed} \quad \cdot \quad \text{cover height} = \text{trim height} + 0.25"$$

Spine text needs roughly 100+ pages of thickness; keep it 0.0625" away from spine edges.

4 · Color, resolution, files

- ☐ All raster art at **300 DPI** at final print size (never upscale to get there)
- ☐ KDP accepts RGB PDFs and converts to CMYK; expect slight darkening of saturated colors

- ☐ Body text and lettering in **pure black**, not rich black or dark gray builds
- ☐ All fonts **embedded** in the PDF
- ☐ Transparency flattened; no layers, comments, or form fields
- ☐ One single PDF for the interior; cover as its own single-page PDF
- ☐ Page count is even and matches what you enter in KDP
- ☐ No trim marks, registration marks, or color bars in the file

5 · The ten classic rejection causes

- ☐ Wrong PDF page size for the trim you selected
- ☐ Art meant to bleed that stops at the trim line
- ☐ Live text or panels drifting into the gutter
- ☐ Fonts not embedded
- ☐ Images below 300 DPI (soft, pixelated print)
- ☐ Cover spine width wrong for the page count
- ☐ Barcode zone on the back cover not kept clear (2" × 1.2")
- ☐ Interior page 1 starting on the wrong side (odd pages are right-hand)
- ☐ ISBN/imprint page mismatch with KDP metadata
- ☐ Copyrighted content you cannot prove rights to

6 · Digital siblings (webtoon & CBZ)

- ☐ Webtoon strip: **800 px wide**, episodes sliced into pieces no taller than **1280 px**, JPG/PNG under 20 MB per episode
- ☐ CBZ: page images numbered in reading order, RGB, 2000 px+ on the long edge reads well on tablets

Assembled by Sloom Studio, the creative suite you own: comic and book layout, lettering, and print-ready export (KDP-ready PDF, press-ready PDF with bleed and trim, CBZ, webtoon) in one app, one-time purchase. Templates in this pack match the sizes above.

sloom.studio/comic-software-you-own.html

Standards above are the long-stable published ones; before a big print run, verify current values on KDP's print specifications page.